

TO MY HEALTHCARE PROVIDER(S)

This birth plan outlines my preferences and requests for my labor and delivery. I understand that unforeseen circumstances may necessitate deviations from this plan, and I am open to discussing alternatives with you. However, this document serves as formal notice of my wishes and priorities, and I request that you give them serious consideration. I appreciate your collaboration in making my birth experience as safe, positive, and aligned with my preferences as possible.

THE JOYFUL BIRTH PLAN

SECTION 1

About Me & My Preferences

Mother's Name:

Due Date:

Partner's Name (if applicable):

Phone Number:

Email Address:

Doctors Name:

Birth Support (and relationship):

SECTION 2

Labor & Delivery Preferences

CLOTHING PREFERENCE CLOTHING PREFERENCE

☐

Hospital Gown
Hospital Gown

☐

No Clothing
My Own Clothes

☐

My Own Clothes (Specify type)

FETAL MONITORING

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Check all that apply; explain preferences if needed.
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☐

Continuous External Monitoring (Belly Band)
Continuous External Monitoring (Belly Band)

☐

Bluetooth Fetal Monitoring (If available)
Intermittent External Monitoring (Doppler)

☐

Intermittent External Monitoring (Doppler)
Internal Fetal Monitoring (Internal Electrode)

☐

Internal Fetal Monitoring (Internal Electrode)
Bluetooth Fetal Monitoring (If available)

IV/SALINE LOCK

☐

IV Access

☐

No IV/Saline Lock (If selecting this, please explain your rationale)

☐

Saline Lock Only

EATING AND DRINKING DURING LABOR

Specify preferences.

☐ Yes

☐ No

LABOR ENVIRONMENT

Check all that apply; describe your ideal environment.

☐ Dim Lighting

☐ Bright Lighting/Music

☐ Specific Scents/Music

☐ Aromatherapy
Comfort Items (e.g., blanket, pillow)

☐ Other Environments (e.g., bare feet, pillow)

☐ Other Environmental Preferences

COUNTER PRESSURE

Describe your preference for counter-pressure application, if desired. Specify location, pressure level, and whether you want continuous or intermittent pressure.

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Ex.: "Yes, firm counter pressure on my lower back during contractions."

Describe your preference for counter-pressure application, if desired. Specify location, pressure level, and whether you want continuous or intermittent pressure.

☐ Yes

Ex.: "Yes, firm counter pressure on my lower back during contractions."

☐ No

☐ No

PHYSICAL TOUCH

Specify your preference for other types of physical touch, such as massage, back rub, holding hands, etc.

☐

Yes

☐

No

PAIN MANAGEMENT

Rank in order of preference.

☐

None

☐

Spinal Oxide

☐

Spinal Oxide (not standard)

☐

Other (Specify)

INDUCTION INTERVENTIONS (If medically necessary)

Rank in order of preference, or "Not Applicable".

☐

Membrane Sweep

☐

Amniotomy (Artificial Rupture of Membranes)

☐

Cytotec

☐

Pitocin

☐

Other (Specify)

☐

Balloon Foley

BIRTHING INTERVENTIONS (If medically necessary)

Rank in order of preference, or "Not Applicable".

☐

Forceps

☐

Vacuum Extraction

☐

Episiotomy

☐

Other (Specify)

MOVEMENT DURING LABOR

☐

Free movement (walk, change positions as needed)

☐

Primarily in bed

☐

Exercise ball

☐

Peanut ball

CERVICAL CHECKS

Specify your preference for other types of physical touch, such as massage, back rubs, holding hands, etc.

- ☐ Yes, only when asked for.
- ☐ Yes (Frequency: _____)
- ☐ Yes, but don't want to know the dilation.
- ☐ No

PUSHING

- ☐ Mother-Led Pushing (intuitive pushing)
- ☐ Coached Pushing (guided by healthcare provider or birth coach)

MIRROR DURING DELIVERY

- ☐ Yes ☐ No

PHOTOGRAPHY/VIDEOGRAPHY

- ☐ Photos Only ☐ Video Only ☐ Both Photos and Video ☐ Neither

SAFE WORD (For indicating a need to switch to medicated birth if coping becomes difficult)

ANY BIRTH WORD PREFERENCE (Ex. Contractions being called surges or waves)

SECTION 3

Post-Delivery Preferences

IMMEDIATE SKIN-TO-SKIN

☐ Yes ☐ No

DELAYED CORD CLAMPING

☐ Yes ☐ No

- ☐ After specified time
- ☐ Until placenta is completely drained and cord is limp and white

CUTTING THE CORD

☐ Partner ☐ Myself ☐ Other (Specify)

PLACENTA DELIVERY

☐ Spontaneous (natural delivery) ☐ Dr. Assisted ☐ Pitocin-assisted (if medically indicated)

PLACENTA RETENTION

☐ Discard Placenta ☐ Keep Placenta

POSTPARTUM PITOCIN

☐ Yes ☐ No (If selecting no, please explain rationale)

GOLDEN HOUR (Undisturbed bonding time immediately following birth)

FEEDING METHOD

☐ Breastfeeding

☐ Bottle Feeding (specify type of formula, if applicable)

☐ Both

SECTION 4

Newborn Care Preferences

ANTIBACTERIAL EYE OINTMENT

☐ Yes ☐ No

HEPATITIS B VACCINE

☐ Yes ☐ No

VITAMIN K SHOT

☐ Yes ☐ No

VERNIX CLEANING

Rubbing vernix onto baby's skin or being wiped off

☐ Leave ☐ Wipe off
Yes No

CIRCUMCISION

☐ Yes ☐ No

☐ In hospital

☐ At doctor's office

NEWBORN CARE LOCATION

☐ Rooming-in (baby stays with mother) ☐ Nursery (baby stays in nursery) ☐ Both- at my request

BABY FOOTPRINTS

☐ Yes ☐ No

PKU METABOLIC SCREENING

Other Information

ANY OTHER IMPORTANT PREFERENCES OR CONSIDERATIONS

SECTION 5
Other Information
Disclaimer: This birth plan is a guide to assist communication with your healthcare provider. Medical needs may necessitate changes to the plan. It's essential to discuss all aspects of this plan with your healthcare provider and agree on a feasible course of action based on your individual circumstances.

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